

# Negative results and claim revision

Project: Reproducible AI Research Study

## 1. Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

### Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of negative results and claim revision

#### Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

**Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

**Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

**Resources:** Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

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**Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

**Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

**Resources:** Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

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**Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

**Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

**Resources:** Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

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This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

## Retrieval answer guidance

### Robustness across conditions

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Robustness across conditions. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of robustness across conditions

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Robustness checks examine a frozen procedure under declared varied conditions. Performance differences do not by themselves identify cause. Keep baseline, metric and eligibility aligned across conditions. Report condition counts and failures separately; new conditions may extend evidence but cannot guarantee all conditions.

### Running the primary experiment

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Running the primary experiment. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of running the primary experiment

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: The primary experiment follows the frozen plan and captures every eligible outcome. Unexpected failures are recorded rather than silently retried away. Run declared cases, store raw paired results and deviations, and keep primary analysis separate from exploratory repairs. Stop or escalate only according to the stated rule.

### Pilot experiments

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Pilot experiments. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of pilot experiments

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A pilot checks feasibility, measurement and failure handling before the primary study. Pilot results used for revision are development evidence. Run a small fixture set to test data capture, timing boundaries, rubric and analysis code. Fix defects and freeze the revised plan before new primary cases.

Two 45-minute sessions. Negative results report that the evidence did not meet a declared expectation. They can reveal design limits or useful constraints without proving no effect anywhere. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

### Outcomes

Explain the mechanism and terminology of negative results and claim revision

Apply the stated procedure to a new case with a traceable result

Identify an assumption or limitation and design a revealing follow-up

## Preparation

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

## Prerequisite answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

## End goal for the pictorial case

Explain negative results and claim revision using the records and boundaries of this fictional investigation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

## 2. Explain and model the mechanism

Negative results report that the evidence did not meet a declared expectation. They can reveal design limits or useful constraints without proving no effect anywhere.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Compare results with the original criterion and uncertainty assumptions. Preserve the failed hypothesis, discuss plausible mechanisms and label revised questions as new work.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

### Term · Meaning

**Term:** Negative result

**Meaning:** Evidence failing to meet the declared expectation

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**Term:** Claim revision

**Meaning:** A bounded change to the conclusion

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**Term:** Equivalence

**Meaning:** A separate claim requiring its own design and criterion

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## Negative results and claim revision — evidence trace

### Input and scope · Check or calculation · Conclusion and limit

**Input and scope:** Hypothesis expects B support strictly above A. Both pass 8/10 reserved cases.

**Check or calculation:** Compare results with the original criterion and uncertainty assumptions. Preserve the failed hypothesis, discuss plausible mechanisms and label revised questions as new work.

**Conclusion and limit:** Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness.

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The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Guided: Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness. Qualification: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

## Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Hypothesis expects B support strictly above A. Both pass 8/10 reserved cases.

Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

### Thinking move · Teacher prompt

**Thinking move:** Plan

**Teacher prompt:** What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

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**Thinking move:** Do

**Teacher prompt:** Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

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**Thinking move:** Check

**Teacher prompt:** Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

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Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

### A pictorial worked case: Negative results and claim revision

A negative result changes the claim. A proposed prompt improvement ties the baseline on a fixed eight-case evaluation.

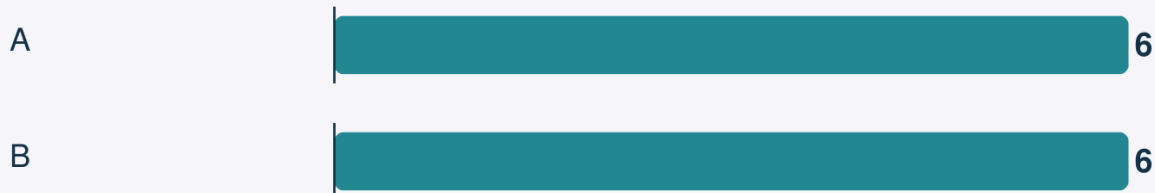
#### The facts we will use

A and B each score 6/8. Before running, the team predicted B would score higher.

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### No observed count advantage

correct cases out of 8 shared cases



Bar length shows the supplied value; the marked baseline is zero.

## Negative results and claim revision

### Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



### 1. Recall the prediction

The claim was a higher correct count for B.



### 2. State the finding

Both versions score 75%; no observed count advantage appears here.



### 3. Revise cautiously

Report the unsupported prediction and a justified next test.

### CHANGE ONE THING

B wins on one new task after the team chooses it because A fails.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

## Read the picture one step at a time

### Step · What happens and why

**Step:** 1. Recall the prediction

**What happens and why:** The claim was a higher correct count for B.

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**Step:** 2. State the finding

**What happens and why:** Both versions score 75%; no observed count advantage appears here.

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### Step: 3. Revise cautiously

**What happens and why:** Report the unsupported prediction and a justified next test.

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Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

### Why this result follows

A negative result can be informative when methods and limits are clear. A tie does not prove the methods are equivalent under all conditions or that the experiment was worthless.

### What this example does not establish

A tie on eight cases is not an equivalence test; uncertainty and practical thresholds remain unspecified.

### Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: B wins on one new task after the team chooses it because A fails.

Prediction: Treat that selected demonstration as exploratory, not a replacement for the original result.

Reason: Case selection now depends on outcomes.

### Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

## 3. Demonstrate and guide practice

### Time or stage · Teacher action

**Time or stage:** Session 1: 0–7 minutes

**Teacher action:** Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.

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**Time or stage:** 7–18 minutes

**Teacher action:** Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.

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**Time or stage:** 18–32 minutes

**Teacher action:** Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.

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**Time or stage:** 32–45 minutes

**Teacher action:** Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.

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**Time or stage:** Session 2: 0–8 minutes

**Teacher action:** Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.

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**Time or stage:** 8–20 minutes

**Teacher action:** Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.

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**Time or stage:** 20–35 minutes

**Teacher action:** Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

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**Time or stage:** 35–45 minutes

**Teacher action:** Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

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Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a prediction before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

## Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Hypothesis expects B support strictly above A. Both pass 8/10 reserved cases. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

## Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Negative results and claim revision. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

### **Pictorial practice question**

Does a 6/8 tie support the prediction that B scores higher? Explain why one newly selected favourable demonstration does not replace the original result or prove equivalence.

### **Reasoned teacher answer**

The claim was a higher correct count for B. Both versions score 75%; no observed count advantage appears here. Report the unsupported prediction and a justified next test. Changed case: Treat that selected demonstration as exploratory, not a replacement for the original result. Case selection now depends on outcomes. A tie on eight cases does not prove equivalence.

Changed-case reasoning: Treat that selected demonstration as exploratory, not a replacement for the original result. Case selection now depends on outcomes.

Collect each learner’s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

## **4. Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions**

The worked result establishes every future case: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Use Section 9 for the evidence ledger. Add a boundary or missing-input case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

### **Match the support to the first error**

#### **What the response shows · Next teaching action**

**What the response shows:** Missing or misread facts

**Next teaching action:** Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

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**What the response shows:** Wrong procedure

**Next teaching action:** Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

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**What the response shows:** Arithmetic or implementation error

**Next teaching action:** Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

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**What the response shows:** Correct result without a reason

**Next teaching action:** Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

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**What the response shows:** An unsupported wider claim

**Next teaching action:** Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

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Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

## 5. Assess and explain the answers

### Guided and exit questions

Guided: Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness. Qualification: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

### W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Negative results report that the evidence did not meet a declared expectation. They can reveal design limits or useful constraints without proving no effect anywhere. Compare results with the original criterion and uncertainty assumptions. Preserve the failed hypothesis, discuss plausible

mechanisms and label revised questions as new work.

## W2 Trace the worked case

Hypothesis expects B support strictly above A. Both pass 8/10 reserved cases. Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: Strict improvement is not observed; both 80%. This does not prove population equality or universal uselessness.

## W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

## W4 Apply a new case independently

Hypothesis predicts mean latency reduction at least 2 seconds. Observed paired mean reduction .8. Report.

Teacher explanation: Practical criterion fails in this sample. Preserve .8-second estimate and limitations; do not redefine the 2-second threshold after viewing results.

## W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. Failure to meet a criterion or reject a null is not proof of exact equivalence. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

## Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4: Practical criterion fails in this sample. Preserve .8-second estimate and limitations; do not redefine the 2-second threshold after viewing results. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: Hypothesis requires zero unauthorised actions; one occurs. Expected reasoning: Criterion fails regardless of other scores. Report and investigate boundary failure. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

## Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Hypothesis predicts mean latency reduction at least 2 seconds. Observed paired mean

reduction .8. Report.

## Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: Practical criterion fails in this sample. Preserve .8-second estimate and limitations; do not redefine the 2-second threshold after viewing results.

### Dimension · Evidence required

**Dimension:** Explanation

**Evidence required:** Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

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**Dimension:** Trace and result

**Evidence required:** Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

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**Dimension:** Limits

**Evidence required:** States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

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Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

## Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

## 6. Connect the project, support and next lesson

Add a labelled negative results and claim revision evidence sheet to Reproducible AI Research Study. Show how you can explain the mechanism and terminology of negative results and claim revision. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

Next connection: Figures that preserve evidence. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its evidence boundary before moving on.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

## Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-7/29, ai-7/31, ai-7/34. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

### Record · Teacher evidence

**Record:** Learner code and date

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Record:** Concept and case used; prior exposure

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Record:** Explanation / trace / limits

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Record:** Support and first repair

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Record:** Changed case and delayed outcome

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Record:** Next teaching action

**Teacher evidence:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive

project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

### **Project evidence from this case**

For the Reproducible AI Research Study, retain an annotated worked trace and the changed-case reasoning. Connect the claim to its records, units and assumptions so another investigator can challenge or reproduce it.